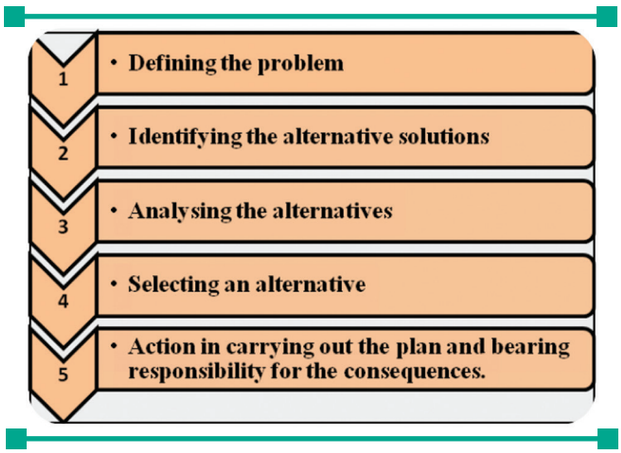


▲ Fig. 3 Steps in Decision making

7.3.2 Types of Decisions

There are different types of decisions namely individual decision, group decision, habitual decision, central decision, economic decision, technical decision and decision making due to experience and knowledge.

- **Individual Decision**
  It is the decision pertaining to an individual e.g. education. Individual decisions are more quickly made. The decision making of an individual revolves around the values, goals, standards and roles the individual assures in the relevant set of frame work.
- **Group Decision**
  It is made from the collective action of several individuals each of whom has distinct values, goals, standards and role perception. It is a difficult process and a slow process. Role conflicts would emerge in this situation.
- **Habitual Decision**
  It is the lowest level of decision. Once an individual is trained to do systematic work, he will follow that throughout his life. They are routine, repetitive actions related to daily activities. Once it becomes a habitual choice, the resultant action is quick and spontaneous.
- **Central Decision**
  Central decision has many supporting decisions to complete the whole task e.g. purchasing a house is a central decision. This leads to look out for other supporting decisions like transportation facilities, community facilities, savings etc.
- **Economic Decision**
  It is based on allocation and exchange process relating to resource use. This decision needs the allocation of human and non-human resources to attain a goal. It reveals the allocation of resources among the combination of goals that will bring about the greatest degree of satisfaction.
- **Technical Decision**
  This decision involves a decision, which will enable the best combination of resources to achieve the stated goal.

Decisions must be made based on past experiences and knowledge. This helps a person to become more efficient and skilled in decision making process.

7.4 FAMILY RESOURCES

Resources can be defined as anything we use to achieve what we want (our goals). In other words, they are the materials and human attributes which satisfy our wants.

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